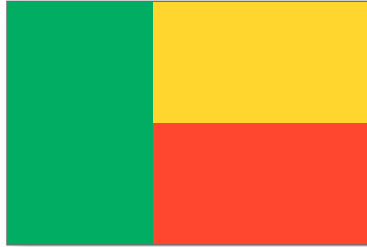


Benin

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** November 16, 1959 **Usage:** National and Civil

Red, yellow, and green are pan-African colors. The colors symbolize African unity and nationalism.



Africa



Originally known as Dahomey, **Benin** became autonomous in 1958 and independent from France in 1960. Its name was changed in 1975.

The flag used today is the same as that adopted in 1959, although after the revolution of December 1975, a green flag with a red star in the canton was used. The original flag was restored in 1990, as was the original national emblem. The new name of the country was retained. Benin has both a seal and a coat of

arms. The seal depicts a *pirogue* or African canoe with a bow and arrow, and two clubs. The arms consists of a quartered shield depicting a local Somba fortress, the medal of the Order of the Star of Benin, a palm tree, and a sailing ship. The motto is “*Fraternité, Justice, Travail*” meaning “Fraternity, Justice, Work.”

ARMS OF BENIN

